

Glossary: Data Visualization

Welcome! This alphabetized glossary contains many terms used in this course. Understanding these terms is essential when working in the industry, participating in user groups, and participating in other certificate programs.

Estimated reading time: 2 minutes

Term	Definition
Bar chart	A pictorial representation of data in the form of vertical or horizontal rectangular bars. In bar charts, the length of bars is proportional to the measure of the data.
Big data	A vast and diverse collection of data points that increases in volume, velocity, and variety.
Binary variable	Variable which has only two variables, that is, one dependent and one independent variable.
Boxplot	A graphical depiction of numerical data helps us to comprehend and analyze its distribution readily.
Bubble chart	A graph that uses circles to represent the data.
Categorical variable	A variable that assigns each unit of observation to a group based on a qualitative property.
Counterplot	Refers to the number of times each observation appears in a categorical variable. It provides a visual representation of the distribution of observations in the variable.
Descriptive statistics	A statistic that summarizes the characteristics of a sample through quantitative or visual means.
Dichotomous variable	Variables that only take on two possible values.
Histogram	A graph displays a frequency distribution with continuous classes grouped.
Mean	An average of the given numbers. It is calculated by dividing the sum of the given numbers by the total number of observations.
Median	A function that separates the higher value of a data sample, a population, or a probability distribution from the lower value.
Mode	A value that appears frequently in the data set.

Term	Definition
Normal distribution curve	A frequency distribution that is symmetric around the mean, which indicates a higher occurrence of data near the mean than far from it.
Pie chart	A circular statistical presentation of data.
Scatter plot	Graphs are used to represent the relationship between two variables in the data sets.
Standard deviation	A measure of the amount of variation or dispersion of a set of values.
Statistics	A branch of study that analyzes and manipulates data.
Statistical analysis	A process to collect and analyze large amounts of data to identify trends and patterns.
Statistical parameter	A summary statistic is a parameter that describes an aspect of a statistical population, such as its mean or standard deviation.

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